

Besides, sanction has been accorded for setting up a regional Postgraduate Centre of Maharshi Dayanand University at Mirpur in Rewari District and a regional Postgraduate Centre of Kurukshetra University has been set up in Jind. It has been decided to set up a regional Postgraduate Centre of Foreign and English Language University, Hyderabad, at Meham in Rohtak District.

A Business School and a Knowledge Park are being set up on the campus of Guru Jambheshwar University in Hisar. The Deen Bandhu Chhotu Ram Engineering College, Murthal, has been upgraded as Deen Bandhu Chhotu Ram Science and Technology University. GJU at Hisar has also been upgraded as a Science and Technology University and as many as 131 technical institutes have been opened in the State.

Enabling the private sector to play a vital role in the field of education, the Haryana Private Universities Act, 2006, has been

enacted to promote competition in higher education and encourage setting up of educational institutions for higher education of international standard. Nine proposals have been received so far from private institutions under the Act.

STRESS ON JOB-ORIENTED COURSES

What's more, job-oriented courses have been started in government colleges and seats in technical colleges have been increased from 31,000 to 1.25 lakh. EDUSAT network scheme has been implemented in all colleges. Government women's colleges have been set up at Panchkula, Tosham, Panipat, Chhachhrauli, Balwala (Hisar), Lakhan Majra and Rewari and government colleges have been set up at Kaithal, Julana, Mandi Dabwali and Birohar. A women's wing has been opened at Government College, Sirsa.

The state government has also introduced semester system at the under-graduate level in Science

and Commerce faculties with effect from the academic session 2009-10. The semester system is already being followed at the post-graduate level successfully. Then, with a view to imparting quality education and making the students aware of the changing global academic needs, setting up of private universities has been permitted in the state. This will enable the students to better adapt themselves to the changing academic scenario.

SOFT SKILLS SCHEME

This scheme was started in 2005-06 in six government colleges of the state. It is meant for upgrading the knowledge of English of students and giving them an intensive training in communication skills and interpersonal skills, particularly for BPO industry and the IT sector.

The Soft Skills programme is divided into three components of 128 DVDs which include presentations on grammar, voice and accent, communication skills,

customer service, global culture and computer proficiency. A work book is provided on soft skills with a software for additional practice.

Besides, the state government has decided to establish English Labs in 25 government colleges which are to be developed as Centres of Excellence. It becomes imperative that emphasis be laid on learning the English Language and its usage. The requirement of the students in Haryana is unique vis-a-vis spoken or communicative English. These English Labs would be beneficial as these would enable the students to learn by themselves. Communicative English as add on course too would be introduced. The proposal is named "Certificate course in communication skill".

Given the wide range of activities and efforts made on revamping and broadening the education sector, Haryana seems well on way to becoming an education hub which would soon begin to draw students from far and wide.

